

7 Security

Sharing only

An account type meant for remote users only. This type of an account cannot login to the computer normally at the standard desktop.

Group

A group account consists of several accounts and lets you regulate privileges for a set of accounts.

After choosing the account type, you will be required to submit an account name and password. If this is a high security account, you have the option of ticking the “Turn on File Vault Protection” checkbox.



Secure your privacy with File Vault

7.2 The File Vault Menu

File Vault

An option found on versions starting Mac OS X 10.3 (Panther), file vault is a file protection system that encrypts your files before saving to hard disk, thus making them inaccessible to others. Similar to features found in Windows' NTFS file system, file vault encrypts your entire home directory. File vault turns the directory into an encrypted file system, which is decrypted and mounted when you log in. Turn this facility on when you intend to use an account for storing important/personal data. If you enable File Vault protection, you will have a further option to turn on secure virtual memory. This is a further security measure, which encrypts your virtual memory also.